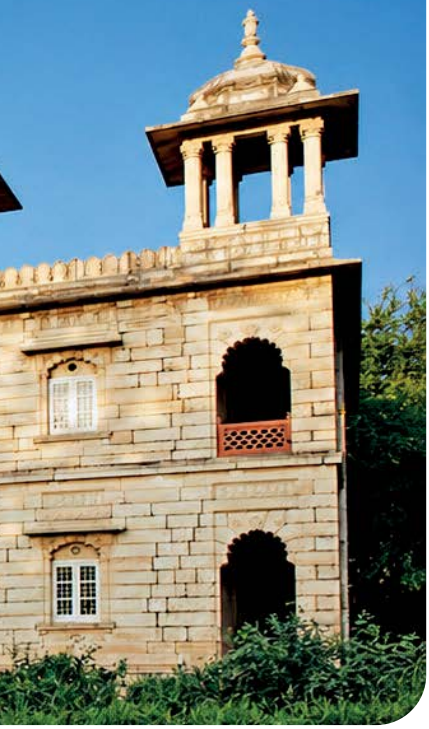
Commissioned by Maharaja Sayajirao Gaekwad III in 1936, the E-shaped monument was designed by Edwin Lutyens

the family has signalled wider ambitions for the sprawling campus, which houses a Shiv temple, the Kubereshwar Dutt temple and an art gallery—envisioning it as a cultural and leisure space, with the historic Vishwamitri ghats to be cleaned and revived. ■

—Jumana Shah



ART ▼

Meaning in **Metal**

Artist and designer Ashiesh Shah's first solo exhibition in London is anchored by copper



Taamr is Sanskrit for copper, which is where Ashiesh Shah's eponymous show at the Carpenters Workshop Gallery in London began, not as material but as an idea. The Copper Age was the moment humans stopped accepting materials as they found them and began transforming them. That felt right for where Shah's atelier is. "*Taamr* is us setting the brackets down, designing here, crafting there, and making art somewhere else. Eight works, none of them interested in telling you which shelf they belong on," he says.

Among the works is 'Dveep', a coffee table that thinks about Mumbai, and mirror mosaic panes linked by strands of Channapatna beads, like the causeways that stitched seven islands into one city. The 'Kumbh Mirror' layers thousands of rudraksha beads around a circular frame until texture replaces ornament and, at the centre, your own reflection. 'Matka Mobile' suspends bronze vessels in slow orbit. In every piece, the inherited form leads.

'MATKA MOBILE' SUSPENDS BRONZE VESSELS IN SLOW ORBIT. IN EVERY PIECE, THE INHERITED FORM LEADS

"Copper refuses to stay finished. It darkens with air, brightens where hands touch it, and records everything that happens to it. Most materials in design are sealed against time. Copper insists on living through it," explains Shah. ■

—Bindu Gopal Rao

On view at the Carpenters Workshop Gallery, London, until Sept. 20



BOLD EXPRESSIONS Sheba Chhachhi's 'Strange Manufactory' installation; (left) Jai Chuhan's 'Madonna'

The exhibition moves from bodily autonomy and institutional confinement towards political testimony, ecological uncertainty, land, myth and inheritance. Sheba addresses pharmaceutical exploitation and feminist protest, while Mumtaz's portraits document women activists and overlooked histories of feminist and anti-colonial resistance. Jai reclaims the Western nude through a female gaze, while Jasleen reworks colonial archives alongside domestic ceramics. Ashfika considers climate-change-induced geographic uncertainty, while Anju and Gurminder explore women's relationships with the natural world. Leela, one of modern India's pioneering women sculptors, is represented through sculpture and drawing, while a new work by Arpita concludes the exhibition.

Linsey's international curatorial perspective places these practices within a broader feminist art-historical dialogue. For Vadehra, this reflects the gallery's commitment to "situating the artists we work with within a wider art-historical conversation of South Asian art being an important part of the global contemporary art dialogue". ■

—Nikhil Sardana

On view until Sept. 18